Clockwise from below left: Bukhara at ITC Maurya is an icon restaurant in India; Dum Pukht celebrates the art of slow cooking; Ramachandran's Ashoka After Kalinga, a bronze sculpture at ITC Maurya; Royal Vega Thali is a lavish dining experience



"The chefs and managers know exactly your taste. You don't have to tell them. The beauty is, they remember."

DOCTOR AND PROFESSOR SANJEEV BAGAI









WHEN FOOD BECAME A LEGEND

Perhaps nothing built the wide appeal of ITC Hotels as much as restaurants like Bukhara at ITC Maurya which famously became a destination in its own right. Calling Bukhara in a "league of its own," one of the country's top chefs, Manish Mehrotra, reflects on why the restaurant achieved cult status. "It is one place consistently giving the same food, the same atmosphere, the same experience, time after time. Anybody can open and run a restaurant, but keeping it consistent, that is amazing. Even after not changing the menu for nearly 50 years, Bukhara is still packed every day."

While Bukhara wears the crown, other signature restaurants like Dum Pukht, Royal Vega, Avartana, Peshawri, Yi Jing, Ottimo and Pavilion have carved out reputations of their own. Avartana at ITC Grand Chola in Chennai puts a modern spin on South Indian cuisine. Its degustation menus bring together familiar regional flavours with creative techniques, interesting textures and beautiful plating. What many don't know is that ITC Hotels also have food sherpas who guide guests to places where they can sample the best local cuisine in that city.

